

2 Subject content and assessment information

The subject content sets out the knowledge, understanding and skills relevant to this qualification. Together with the assessment information it provides the framework within which centres create their programmes of study, so ensuring progression from Key Stage 3 national curriculum requirements and the possibilities for development into A Level.

Qualification aims and objectives

GCSE specifications for the discipline of geography give students the opportunity to understand more about the world, the challenges it faces and their place within it. This GCSE course will deepen understanding of geographical processes, illuminate the impact of change and of complex people-environment interactions, highlight the dynamic links and interrelationships between places and environments at different scales, and develop students' competence in using a wide range of geographical investigative skills and approaches. Geography enables young people to become globally and environmentally informed and thoughtful, enquiring citizens.

The aims and objectives of this qualification are to enable students to build on their Key Stage 3 knowledge and skills to:

- develop and extend their knowledge of locations, places, environments and processes, and of different scales, including global; and of social, political and cultural contexts (know geographical material)
- gain understanding of the interactions between people and environments, change in places and processes over space and time, and the interrelationship between geographical phenomena at different scales and in different contexts (think like a geographer)
- develop and extend their competence in a range of skills including those used in fieldwork, in using maps and Geographical Information Systems (GIS) and in researching secondary evidence, including digital sources; and develop their competence in applying sound enquiry and investigative approaches to questions and hypotheses (study like a geographer)
- apply geographical knowledge, understanding, skills and approaches appropriately and creatively to real world contexts, including fieldwork, and to contemporary situations and issues; and develop well-evidenced arguments drawing on their geographical knowledge and understanding (applying geography).

Geographical Skills

Students are required to develop a range of geographical skills, including mathematics and statistics skills, throughout their course of study. These skills may be assessed across any of the examined papers. The full list of geographical skills is provided on page 32. Some geographical skills are specific to particular topic content, these are numbered within the content and indicated in the 'integrated skills' sections within the topics throughout the content pages.

Subject content structure

The subject content has been written so that each topic in Component 1 and 2 is introduced by way of a geographical overview before progressing into geographical depth. Geographical overview content aims to develop students' broad, holistic understanding of the topic theme at a larger scale. Geographical depth content aims to develop students' detailed knowledge and understanding of processes and interactions in a particular smaller scale place or context.

Case Studies and located examples

All students must study three in-depth case studies:

- In Topic 4 Changing cities, a case study of a major UK city
- In Topic 4 Changing cities, a case study of a major city in a developing country or an emerging country
- In Topic 5 Global development, a case study of development in a developing country or an emerging country.

In addition to the three in-depth case studies, throughout the course it is a requirement to draw on located examples from developing, emerging and developed countries. Any located examples must be set within the broader contextual knowledge of the country. In order to make it clear where a located example should be developed, a 🌐 symbol has been used.

Programmes of study could identify located examples within the countries selected for the three in-depth case studies.

Component 1: The Physical Environment

Overview

This component brings together physical geography and people-environment processes and interactions. The component is divided into three sections:

- Topic 1: The changing landscapes of the UK – an overview of the distribution and characteristics of the UK's changing landscapes and detailed studies of **two** from three landscapes, 1A: Coastal landscapes and processes, 1B: River landscapes and processes or 1C: Glaciated upland landscapes and processes
- Topic 2: Weather hazards and climate change – an overview of the global circulation of atmosphere and climate change over time and a detailed study of tropical cyclones and a drought
- Topic 3: Ecosystems, biodiversity and management – an overview of the distribution and characteristics of global and UK ecosystems and a detailed study of tropical rainforests and deciduous woodlands.

Content